Lesson 8 — The Line We Share

Part 9 of 12: Writing — If the Connection Failed Tonight

Level: B1 (eighth step)

About 35 minutes · this part carries a sheet

5.2 Writing — "If the Connection Failed Tonight" (14–16 sentences)

Model answer (copy the shape, change the words):

> Our building shares one line with the two beside it, and everything we do depends on it. If the uplink fails, nobody has a second way in, so I have a plan for both kinds of evening. I download everything I will need on Sunday, when the latency is low and nobody is sending anything large. If my class goes down on Monday, I will read the slides I already have and send my questions as messages. If it does not go down, I have lost twenty quiet minutes and nothing else. We keep one rule in the group, and it is enough: tell the others before you send something big. If two people ignore it on the same night, everybody knows within a minute. People sometimes ask me what I would do with a faster connection. If I had one, I would stop planning around it and put that hour into the work itself, and I would stop apologising at the start of every call. If I were honest, though, the plan is not only about the line. I will keep making it after the line improves, because a week with a plan is steadier than a week without one. As soon as I pass the language test I will send the application, and if it is refused I will send it again in the spring.

Checklist before you send it:

- [ ] I used the first conditional at least four times, with present simple + will.
- [ ] I used the second conditional at least twice, with past simple + would.
- [ ] I used if I were, not if I was, in writing.
- [ ] I used unless, or as soon as / when with a present simple, at least once.
- [ ] I put a comma after the if-clause only when it came first.
- [ ] I used at least 5 new words from Session 2.
- [ ] I used at least 2 words from Lesson 6 or Lesson 7.
- [ ] My text has 14–16 sentences.